

DAY 3 · SECOND BRAIN SYSTEMS

KASIM ASLAM

SECOND BRAIN

A founder knowledge system — built so that the next Right Hand can pick it up cold, ask a real question, and land on the right file.

THE ASSIGNMENT

“Build a starter Second Brain for your sample founder: Kasim Aslam. Design the folder architecture. Run an intake from mined material. Populate the context layer with at least five documents. Run the retrieval test and record it. Prepare a quick tutorial for your founder showing how it works.”

THE STRUCTURE

```
KASIM-ASLAM-SECOND-BRAIN/
├─ README.md           the whole structure, in plain language
├─ CLAUDE.md           rules for AI working inside the brain
├─ CONTEXT/           what we know
│  └─ _MOC.md          index for this folder
│  └─ identity.md
│  └─ offer-and-pricing.md
│  └─ team-and-key-people.md
│  └─ history.md
│  └─ long-form-source.md
├─ INTAKE/             where it came from
│  └─ _MOC.md
│  └─ source-log.md    every source, and what it gave us
│  └─ raw/             7 source files, commentary stripped
├─ RETRIEVAL-TEST/    the proof it can be searched
└─ TUTORIAL/          for the founder
```

THE FIVE STEPS

#	STEP	WHAT WAS DONE
1	Architecture	Folder tree designed and generated as a zip, then placed in Google Drive
2	Intake	8 sources mined from public material, each one logged and stored
3	Context layer	5 documents built on top of those sources
4	Retrieval test	3 real questions, each recorded with the file it came from
5	Founder tutorial	A walkthrough video showing how to use it

STEPS 1 & 2

STRUCTURE & INTAKE

STEP 1 · ARCHITECTURE

Four folders, each with one job and nothing else: `CONTEXT/` holds what we know, `INTAKE/` holds where it came from, `RETRIEVAL-TEST/` holds the proof it works, `TUTORIAL/` is written for the founder.

Every folder carries a `_MOC.md` — a short index of what is inside it. That is what keeps a question to four hops: **pick the folder → read its MOC → open one file → follow a link if needed.** Never a search through everything.

The whole tree was generated as a zip, unzipped, and placed in Google Drive — the persistent copy that makes the brain available on any device.

STEP 2 · INTAKE

Eight sources, mined from material that already existed. Different *types*, not eight of the same thing — each register exposes something the others cannot.

#	SOURCE	TYPE
1	kasimaslam.com — About	Official website
2	<i>I Can't Separate From My Business</i>	YouTube transcript
3	<i>Terror and Excitement in the Age of AI</i>	LinkedIn post + comments
4	<i>The black box of delegation</i>	LinkedIn post
5	<i>Entrepreneurship Is NOT Fulfillment</i>	Medium article
6-7	<i>Who survives? · Founders: Stop trying to "learn AI"</i>	Facebook posts
8	<i>Your Digital Marketing Autopsy</i> — Perpetual Traffic Ep. 730	Podcast, ~9,000 words

Every source is logged in `INTAKE/source-log.md` with its URL, type and capture date. The raw text is stored with all commentary stripped — a source file contains the source and nothing else, so nothing written by a third party can be mistaken for something he said.

STEP 3

THE CONTEXT LAYER

FIVE DOCUMENTS

DOCUMENT	WHAT IT ANSWERS
<code>identity.md</code>	Who he is, how he positions himself, his credentials
<code>offer-and-pricing.md</code>	What he sells, and what is priced publicly
<code>team-and-key-people.md</code>	The people around him and his companies
<code>history.md</code>	The chronological story, and why he thinks the way he does
<code>long-form-source.md</code>	His frameworks and opinions, in his own words

The longest-form piece is the podcast episode — four times longer than anything else in the brain, and the only place he reasons at length under follow-up questions.

TRACEABILITY

Nothing in `CONTEXT/` is written from memory. Every claim traces back to a file in `INTAKE/raw/`, and every one of those files has a row in `source-log.md` recording where it came from.

If a claim is not traceable to a row in that table, it should not be in `CONTEXT/`.

WHERE IT LIVES

Google Drive	The persistent source of truth — what an assistant reads from, on any device
This folder	The working copy, where it was built and tested

STEP 4

THE RETRIEVAL TEST

Three real questions. The point is not a good-sounding answer — it is naming the file it came from.

“What does the annual plan cost in year one, all in?”

FOUND IN `CONTEXT/offer-and-pricing.md`

Annual — \$36,000 / year — **\$39,000** Year 1, all-in. *Plus a one-time \$3,000 placement fee on the first invoice.*

\$39,000 all-in — \$36,000 for the year plus the \$3,000 placement fee. The file also carries the warning that a third figure circulating online is a conflation, not a real plan, so the number came back with its caveat attached.

“What’s my framework for delegation?”

FOUND IN `CONTEXT/long-form-source.md`

Two documented layers:

- **The black box of delegation** — “you’re allowed to define the input and the output. So the output is your desired end result. That’s what you should define first.” Delegate projects, not tasks.
- **Five steps out of identity fusion** — name the dependency · get a therapist · confront the self-enhancement bias · name your fear of competence · separate busy from valuable.

“Who else is behind Pareto Talent?”

FOUND IN `CONTEXT/team-and-key-people.md`

Three people verifiable by name: **Ivan Bunin** (Co-Founder; hired as Kasim’s EA in 2018, rose to CTO, co-author of *HIRE*) · “**Ampy**” (first internal hire — first name only) · **John Moran** (Chief Strategist, Solutions 8).

And the gap is reported, not filled. Pareto Talent publishes no team page. A fourth name circulates on data aggregators; the file carries it marked `UNVERIFIED` so nobody mistakes it for a contact.

WHAT THE TEST SHOWS

BEHAVIOUR	RESULT
Found the right file, not just a plausible answer	All three
Returned a number with its caveat attached	Question 1
Found a named framework, not only a fact	Question 2
Reported a gap instead of filling it	Question 3
Needed a read of the whole brain to answer	Never — one folder each

STEP 5

FOUNDER TUTORIAL

A short walkthrough showing how the Second Brain works — how to ask it a question, and how to put something new into it.

WATCH THE TUTORIAL

<https://www.loom.com/share/bf55bb4a049d4129b4c27c8007c09402>

Built with Loom · opens in a new tab

WHAT IT COVERS

- How to ask a question — and why the answer always names its file.
- How to add a new source: put the text in `INTAKE/raw/`, add a row to `source-log.md`, then update the `CONTEXT/` file it feeds.
- Where the brain lives, and which copy is the source of truth.

THE WRITTEN COMPANION

`TUTORIAL/founder-quick-start.md` — the same material as a one-page reference, for when watching a video is not convenient.

The one rule the whole brain rests on. If the answer is not in here, say so. Do not fill a gap with something plausible — the brain is useful because every claim in it traces back to a source. One invented detail makes all of it untrustworthy.